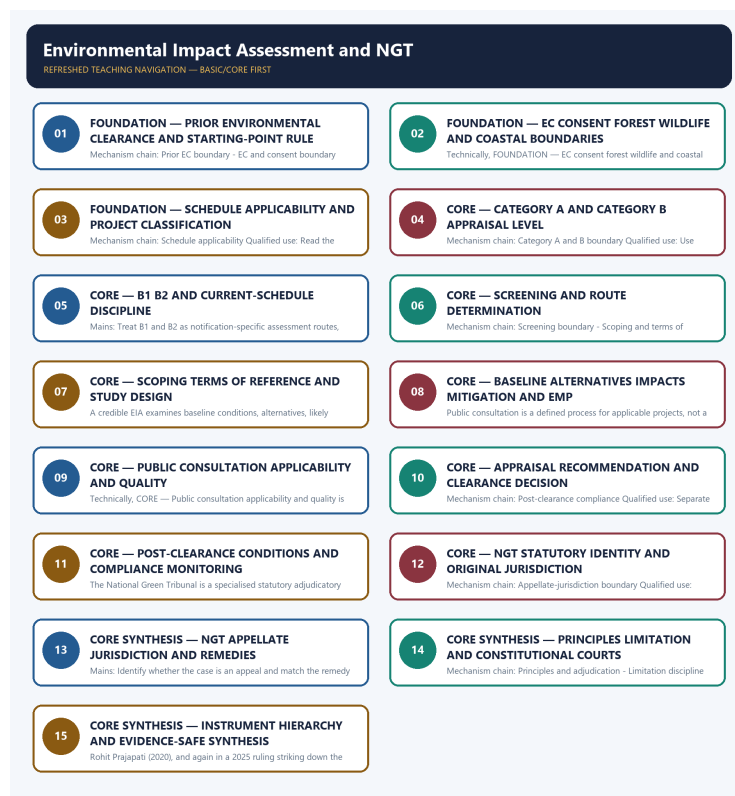


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session	6
SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT	6
LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG	6
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	7
DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT	7
EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL	7
SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - PRIOR ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE AND STARTING-POINT RULE	9
SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - EC CONSENT FOREST WILDLIFE AND COASTAL BOUNDARIES	10
SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY AND PROJECT CLASSIFICATION	11
SESSION 4 - CORE - CATEGORY A AND CATEGORY B APPRAISAL LEVEL	13
SESSION 5 - CORE - B1 B2 AND CURRENT-SCHEDULE DISCIPLINE	14
SESSION 6 - CORE - SCREENING AND ROUTE DETERMINATION	16
SESSION 7 - CORE - SCOPING TERMS OF REFERENCE AND STUDY DESIGN	17
SESSION 8 - CORE - BASELINE ALTERNATIVES IMPACTS MITIGATION AND EMP	18
SESSION 9 - CORE - PUBLIC CONSULTATION APPLICABILITY AND QUALITY	20
SESSION 10 - CORE - APPRAISAL RECOMMENDATION AND CLEARANCE DECISION	21
SESSION 11 - CORE - POST-CLEARANCE CONDITIONS AND COMPLIANCE MONITORING	23
SESSION 12 - CORE - NGT STATUTORY IDENTITY AND ORIGINAL JURISDICTION	25
SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - NGT APPELLATE JURISDICTION AND REMEDIES	26
SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - PRINCIPLES LIMITATION AND CONSTITUTIONAL COURTS	27
SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - INSTRUMENT HIERARCHY AND EVIDENCE-SAFE SYNTHESIS	29
ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL	38
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	38
Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Prior EC boundary?	38
Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Prior EC boundary?	39
Q3. Which statement uses Prior EC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	39
Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Prior EC boundary?	39
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies EC and consent boundary?	39
Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of EC and consent boundary?	40

Q7. Which statement uses EC and consent boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	40
Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about EC and consent boundary?	40
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Multiple-clearance boundary?	40
Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Multiple-clearance boundary?	41
Q11. Which statement uses Multiple-clearance boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	41
Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Multiple-clearance boundary?	41
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule applicability?	41
Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule applicability?	42
Q15. Which statement uses Schedule applicability without changing its scale, parameter or status?	42
Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule applicability?	42
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category A and B boundary?	42
Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category A and B boundary?	43
Q19. Which statement uses Category A and B boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	43
Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category A and B boundary?	43
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies B1 and B2 boundary?	43
Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of B1 and B2 boundary?	44
Q23. Which statement uses B1 and B2 boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	44
Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about B1 and B2 boundary?	44
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Screening boundary?	45
Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Screening boundary?	45
Q27. Which statement uses Screening boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	45
Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Screening boundary?	45
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Scoping and terms of reference?	46
Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Scoping and terms of reference?	46
Q31. Which statement uses Scoping and terms of reference without changing its scale, parameter or status?	46
Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Scoping and terms of reference?	46
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment evidence?	47
Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment evidence?	47
Q35. Which statement uses Assessment evidence without changing its scale, parameter or status?	47
Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment evidence?	47
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Public-consultation boundary?	48
Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Public-consultation boundary?	48

Q39. Which statement uses Public-consultation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	48
Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Public-consultation boundary?	48
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Appraisal and decision?	49
Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appraisal and decision?	49
Q43. Which statement uses Appraisal and decision without changing its scale, parameter or status?	49
Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appraisal and decision?	50
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Post-clearance compliance?	50
Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Post-clearance compliance?	50
Q47. Which statement uses Post-clearance compliance without changing its scale, parameter or status?	50
Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-clearance compliance?	51
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies NGT statutory identity?	51
Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NGT statutory identity?	51
Q51. Which statement uses NGT statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?	51
Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NGT statutory identity?	52
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Original-jurisdiction boundary?	52
Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Original-jurisdiction boundary?	52
Q55. Which statement uses Original-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	52
Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Original-jurisdiction boundary?	53
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	53
Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	53
Q59. Which statement uses Appellate-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	54
Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?	54
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Remedy boundary?	54
Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Remedy boundary?	54
Q63. Which statement uses Remedy boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	55
Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Remedy boundary?	55
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Principles and adjudication?	55
Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Principles and adjudication?	55
Q67. Which statement uses Principles and adjudication without changing its scale, parameter or status?	56
Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Principles and adjudication?	56
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Limitation discipline?	56
Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Limitation discipline?	57

Q71. Which statement uses Limitation discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?	57
Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Limitation discipline?	57
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Constitutional-court boundary?	57
Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Constitutional-court boundary?	58
Q75. Which statement uses Constitutional-court boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	58
Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Constitutional-court boundary?	58
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Instrument and evidence boundary?	58
Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Instrument and evidence boundary?	59
Q79. Which statement uses Instrument and evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	59
Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Instrument and evidence boundary?	59
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	59
AUDITED EIA, CLEARANCE, NGT AND ENVIRONMENTAL-JUSTICE PYQ OWNERSHIP	60
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	60
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	62
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	65
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	67
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	70
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	73
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	78
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	83
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	88
Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: PRIOR EC, DISTINCT APPROVALS, CATEGORY AND PROCESS MAP	88
Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: CONSULTATION, COMPLIANCE, JURISDICTION, REMEDY AND LIMITATION TRAPS	89
Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: EIA-NGT GOVERNANCE ANSWER SPINE	89
Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: LIVE THRESHOLD, EXEMPTION, PENALTY, CASE AND PYQ EVIDENCE BOUNDARY	89
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	89

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision, ecological rate, species count, pollution standard, rule threshold, mission outcome or current status was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Audited ledgers route direct Mains demands on EIA reform, NGO and activist influence, mining hazards and constitutional environmental adjudication, plus objective distinctions between NGT and CPCB and Environment Protection Act powers. No answer key is inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** MoEFCC pages substantively supported only the preventive appraisal function and the NGT's statutory identity. PARIVESH and NGT FAQ pages were title-only, India Code returned HTTP 403 and the NGT home page failed at transport level. No project threshold, category, exemption, clearance stage, limitation period, penalty or current case claim was imported.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports. Stubs, access failures, unrelated pages and thin landing pages are recorded and are not converted into ecological or current-status claims.

- <https://moef.gov.in/environmental-impact-assessment-eia> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page returned substantive but visibly legacy procedural text. It supports only the preventive appraisal and monitoring functions; no current category threshold, exemption, timeline or amendment was imported.
- <https://moef.gov.in/national-green-tribunal> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page substantively states that the NGT was established on 18 October 2010 under the NGT Act, 2010 for effective and expeditious environmental adjudication, relief and compensation.
- <https://parivesh.nic.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official portal returned only the title 'PARIVESH'. No clearance category, project threshold, stage, exemption or approval claim was inferred.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/2025?locale=en> - attempted 2026-09-03; India Code returned HTTP 403, so no section, Schedule I boundary, limitation period or penalty was transcribed.
- <https://www.greentribunal.gov.in/hi/node/5096> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official NGT page returned only an FAQ title. No jurisdiction, remedy, limitation or bench claim was imported.
- <https://greentribunal.gov.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official home-page request failed at transport level, so no current tribunal claim was used.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Environment and Ecology Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Ecology boundary	System boundary, scale, trophic level, stock/flow, pool/flux, gross/net, unit and time interval are explicit.
Species boundary	Taxon, range, habitat, population trend, IUCN assessment, Indian legal schedule, CITES/CMS listing and endemism remain distinct.
Law/status boundary	Act, amendment, rule, notification, draft, judgment, policy, target, implementation and observed outcome remain distinct and dated.
Institution boundary	Legal form, parent authority, mandate, jurisdiction, standard, consent, enforcement, science and adjudication are not conflated.
Treaty boundary	Membership, annex/appendix, amendment acceptance, target, COP decision, national instrument and outcome remain distinct.
Climate boundary	Emission flow, concentration stock, cumulative budget, forcing, scenario, baseline, unit, mitigation, adaptation, loss-and-damage, avoidance and removal are exact.
Pollution boundary	Source, emission/load, ambient concentration, exposure, parameter, averaging period, unit, standard and jurisdiction are explicit.
Causal method	Chronology, designation, expenditure, capacity, registration and correlation are not promoted into ecological or policy outcomes without mechanism and evidence.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved : false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\basic\16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\learning-sessions\v2\subject-wide-syllabus\environment-and-ecology-16_Learning-Session.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\advanced\16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT.md **Official syllabus mapping:**
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Environment-and-Ecology\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Ecological mechanisms retain direction, pool, flux, limiting factor, spatial scale and time scale.
- Current species/news claims retain taxon, source, event/publication date, assessment/listing date and access date.
- IUCN category never substitutes for Wildlife Protection Act schedule, CITES appendix, CMS appendix or endemism.
- Protected-area categories, treaty designations and institution mandates retain exact legal character.
- Acts, amendments, rules, draft instruments, notifications and judgments retain operative status and date.
- Climate figures retain unit, baseline, period, scenario and stock-flow character; global evidence is not silently downscaled to India.
- Mitigation, adaptation and loss-and-damage remain separate; allowance, offset, avoidance, removal, capture and storage remain separate.
- PYQ wording is preserved only where verified; reconstructed or routed demands remain labelled.

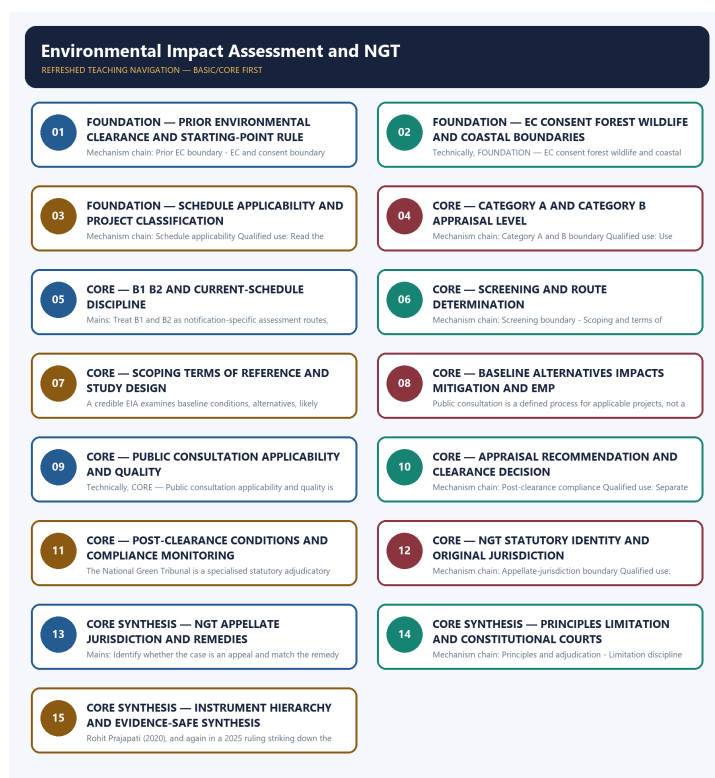
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-03:** volatile targets, standards, schedules, species status, treaty outcomes and programme claims retain source/date/status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://moef.gov.in/environmental-impact-assessment-eia> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page returned substantive but visibly legacy procedural text. It supports only the preventive appraisal and monitoring functions; no current category threshold, exemption, timeline or amendment was imported.
- <https://moef.gov.in/national-green-tribunal> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official MoEFCC page substantively states that the NGT was established on 18 October 2010 under the NGT Act, 2010 for effective and expeditious environmental adjudication, relief and compensation.
- <https://parivesh.nic.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official portal returned only the title 'PARIVESH'. No clearance category, project threshold, stage, exemption or approval claim was inferred.
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- <https://greentribunal.gov.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official home-page request failed at transport level, so no current tribunal claim was used.

Topic 26 dedicated Disaster Management cross-owners (scope boundary):

- Not applicable to this topic.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - PRIOR ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE AND STARTING-POINT RULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Prior EC boundary - EC and consent boundary Qualified use: Start with whether prior EC applies and identify the prohibited starting point.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Prior environmental clearance**
- **starting-point rule**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Prior**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Prior environmental clearance, connect starting-point rule with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PRIOR ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE AND STARTING-POINT RULE

01. Prior EC boundary

|

v

02. EC and consent boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge prior environmental clearance with CTE or CTO.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
- Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge prior environmental clearance with CTE or CTO.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.

- **Mains:** Start with whether prior EC applies and identify the prohibited starting point.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Prior EC boundary -> EC and consent boundary
- **Qualified use:** Start with whether prior EC applies and identify the prohibited starting point.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - PRIOR ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE AND STARTING-POINT RULE

```

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Prior environmental clearance and starting-point rule
    |
    v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Prior environmental clearance · starting-point rule · Mechanism chain ·
Qualified use · Prior
    |
    v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Prior EC boundary - EC and consent boundary Qualified use:
Start with whether prior EC applies and identify the prohibited starting point.
    |
    v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge prior environmental clearance with CTE or CTO.
    |
    v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from
different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
    |
    v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required
before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-
construction certificate of impact management.
  
```

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - EC CONSENT FOREST WILDLIFE AND COASTAL BOUNDARIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Multiple-clearance boundary Qualified use: List every approval separately with its statute, authority and purpose.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - EC consent forest wildlife and coastal boundaries is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to EC consent forest wildlife, then testing the relationship through coastal boundaries and Mechanism chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **EC consent forest wildlife**
- **coastal boundaries**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Multiple-clearance**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define EC consent forest wildlife, connect coastal boundaries with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

EC CONSENT FOREST WILDLIFE AND COASTAL BOUNDARIES

01. Multiple-clearance boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** List every approval separately with its statute, authority and purpose.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Multiple-clearance boundary
- **Qualified use:** List every approval separately with its statute, authority and purpose.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - EC CONSENT FOREST WILDLIFE AND COASTAL BOUNDARIES

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - EC consent forest wildlife and coastal boundaries

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · EC consent forest wildlife · coastal boundaries · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Multiple-clearance

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Multiple-clearance boundary Qualified use: List every approval separately with its statute, authority and purpose.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY AND PROJECT CLASSIFICATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Schedule applicability Qualified use: Read the current schedule before assigning an appraisal route.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Schedule applicability**
- **project classification**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **The first EIA question**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Schedule applicability, connect project classification with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY AND PROJECT CLASSIFICATION

01. Schedule applicability

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume every project follows the same EIA route.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume every project follows the same EIA route.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Read the current schedule before assigning an appraisal route.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Schedule applicability
- **Qualified use:** Read the current schedule before assigning an appraisal route.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY AND PROJECT CLASSIFICATION

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Schedule applicability and project classification
|
v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Schedule applicability · project classification · Mechanism chain ·
Qualified use · The first EIA question
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Schedule applicability Qualified use: Read the current
schedule before assigning an appraisal route.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assume every project follows the same EIA route.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the first EIA question is whether
the proposed project or activity falls within the...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity
falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the
same appraisal route.

SESSION 4 - CORE - CATEGORY A AND CATEGORY B APPRAISAL LEVEL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Category A and B boundary Qualified use: Use Category A or B only for the competent-level distinction supported by the owner.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Category A**
- **Category B appraisal level**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Category**
- **Qualified**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Category A; define Category B appraisal level, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Category for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CATEGORY A AND CATEGORY B APPRAISAL LEVEL

01. Category A and B boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not assign Category A, B, B1 or B2 without the current schedule.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assign Category A, B, B1 or B2 without the current schedule.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use Category A or B only for the competent-level distinction supported by the owner.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Category A and B boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use Category A or B only for the competent-level distinction supported by the owner.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CATEGORY A AND CATEGORY B APPRAISAL LEVEL

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Category A and Category B appraisal level

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Category A · Category B appraisal level · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Category · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Category A and B boundary Qualified use: Use Category A or B only for the competent-level distinction supported by the owner.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assign Category A, B, B1 or B2 without the current schedule.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use Category A or B only for the competent-level distinction supported by the owner.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

SESSION 5 - CORE - B1 B2 AND CURRENT-SCHEDULE DISCIPLINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: B1 and B2 boundary Qualified use: Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

Technical definition: Mains: Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: B1 and B2 boundary Qualified use: Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **B1 B2**
- **current-schedule discipline**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Treat**
- **Qualified**

How to use them: Frame the answer through B1 B2; define current-schedule discipline, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Treat for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

B1 B2 AND CURRENT-SCHEDULE DISCIPLINE

01. B1 and B2 boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge screening with scoping or appraisal.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge screening with scoping or appraisal.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** B1 and B2 boundary
- **Qualified use:** Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - B1 B2 AND CURRENT-SCHEDULE DISCIPLINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - B1 B2 and current-schedule discipline

|

v

EXACT TERMS: B1 B2 • current-schedule discipline • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Treat • Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The operative mechanism is that b1 and B2 boundary Qualified use.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge screening with scoping or appraisal.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: B1 and B2 boundary Qualified use: Treat B1 and B2 as notification-specific assessment routes, never intuition.

SESSION 6 - CORE - SCREENING AND ROUTE DETERMINATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Screening boundary - Scoping and terms of reference Qualified use: Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Screening boundary - Scoping and terms of reference Qualified use: Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Screening
- route determination
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Scoping
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Screening; define route determination, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Scoping for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCREENING AND ROUTE DETERMINATION

01. Screening boundary

|
v

02. Scoping and terms of reference

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat terms of reference as project approval.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
- Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat terms of reference as project approval.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Screening boundary -> Scoping and terms of reference
- **Qualified use:** Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SCREENING AND ROUTE DETERMINATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Screening and route determination

|

↓

EXACT TERMS: Screening · route determination · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Scoping · Qualified

|

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mains: Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

|

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

|

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

|

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Screening boundary - Scoping and terms of reference
Qualified use: Explain screening as route determination rather than final approval.

SESSION 7 - CORE - SCOPING TERMS OF REFERENCE AND STUDY DESIGN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Assessment evidence Qualified use: Connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

Technical definition: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Assessment evidence Qualified use: Connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Scoping terms of reference
- study design
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- EIA
- Assessment

How to use them: Frame the answer through Scoping terms of reference; define study design, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use EIA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCOPING TERMS OF REFERENCE AND STUDY DESIGN

01. Assessment evidence

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume public consultation has no project-specific exceptions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume public consultation has no project-specific exceptions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Assessment evidence
- **Qualified use:** Connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SCOPING TERMS OF REFERENCE AND STUDY DESIGN

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Scoping terms of reference and study design

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Scoping terms of reference · study design · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · EIA · Assessment

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not assume public consultation has no project-specific exceptions.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Assessment evidence Qualified use: Connect scoping to terms of reference and significant-impact selection.

SESSION 8 - CORE - BASELINE ALTERNATIVES IMPACTS MITIGATION AND EMP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Public-consultation boundary Qualified use: Test baseline, alternatives, prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.

Technical definition: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Public-consultation boundary Qualified use: Test baseline, alternatives, prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Baseline alternatives impacts mitigation**
- **EMP**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Public consultation**
- **Qualified**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Baseline alternatives impacts mitigation; define EMP, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Public consultation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

BASELINE ALTERNATIVES IMPACTS MITIGATION AND EMP

01. Public-consultation boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat an expert recommendation as the final clearance order.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat an expert recommendation as the final clearance order.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Test baseline, alternatives, prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Public-consultation boundary
- **Qualified use:** Test baseline, alternatives, prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - BASELINE ALTERNATIVES IMPACTS MITIGATION AND EMP

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Baseline alternatives impacts mitigation and EMP
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Baseline alternatives impacts mitigation · EMP · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
Public consultation · Qualified
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a
universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be
tied to the current notification.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not treat an expert recommendation as the final clearance order.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: test baseline, alternatives,
prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Public-consultation boundary Qualified use: Test
baseline, alternatives, prediction, mitigation and management as one evidence chain.

SESSION 9 - CORE - PUBLIC CONSULTATION APPLICABILITY AND QUALITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Appraisal and decision Qualified use: State consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

Technical definition: Technically, CORE - Public consultation applicability and quality is analysed by relating Public consultation applicability to quality, then testing the relationship through Mechanism chain and Qualified use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Appraisal and decision Qualified use: State consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Public consultation applicability
- quality
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Appraisal
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Public consultation applicability; define quality, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Appraisal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PUBLIC CONSULTATION APPLICABILITY AND QUALITY

01. Appraisal and decision

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat clearance conditions as proof of compliance.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat clearance conditions as proof of compliance.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** State consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Appraisal and decision
- **Qualified use:** State consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PUBLIC CONSULTATION APPLICABILITY AND QUALITY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Public consultation applicability and quality

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Public consultation applicability · quality · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Appraisal · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not treat clearance conditions as proof of compliance.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: state consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Appraisal and decision Qualified use: State consultation applicability, access and response without inventing exemptions.

SESSION 10 - CORE - APPRAISAL RECOMMENDATION AND CLEARANCE DECISION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Post-clearance compliance Qualified use: Separate expert recommendation from the competent authority's final order.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Appraisal recommendation
- clearance decision
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- A granted clearance and listed conditions
- NGT

How to use them: Frame the answer through Appraisal recommendation; define clearance decision, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use A granted clearance and listed conditions for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

APPRAISAL RECOMMENDATION AND CLEARANCE DECISION

01. Post-clearance compliance

BOUNDARY -> Do not call NGT a pollution-control board or appraisal committee.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call NGT a pollution-control board or appraisal committee.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate expert recommendation from the competent authority's final order.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Post-clearance compliance
- **Qualified use:** Separate expert recommendation from the competent authority's final order.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - APPRAISAL RECOMMENDATION AND CLEARANCE DECISION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Appraisal recommendation and clearance decision

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Appraisal recommendation · clearance decision · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · A granted clearance and listed conditions · NGT

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Post-clearance compliance Qualified use: Separate expert recommendation from the competent authority's final order.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not call NGT a pollution-control board or appraisal committee.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not call NGT a pollution-control board or appraisal committee.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

SESSION 11 - CORE - POST-CLEARANCE CONDITIONS AND COMPLIANCE MONITORING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: NGT statutory identity - Original-jurisdiction boundary Qualified use: Move from condition to monitoring, compliance evidence and corrective action.

Technical definition: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: NGT statutory identity - Original-jurisdiction boundary Qualified use: Move from condition to monitoring, compliance evidence and corrective action.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Post-clearance conditions**
- **compliance monitoring**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **The National Green Tribunal**
- **NGT Act**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Post-clearance conditions; define compliance monitoring, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The National Green Tribunal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

POST-CLEARANCE CONDITIONS AND COMPLIANCE MONITORING

01. NGT statutory identity

|

v

02. Original-jurisdiction boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume unlimited NGT jurisdiction over every environmental dispute.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.
- NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume unlimited NGT jurisdiction over every environmental dispute.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Move from condition to monitoring, compliance evidence and corrective action.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** NGT statutory identity -> Original-jurisdiction boundary
- **Qualified use:** Move from condition to monitoring, compliance evidence and corrective action.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - POST-CLEARANCE CONDITIONS AND COMPLIANCE MONITORING

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Post-clearance conditions and compliance monitoring

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Post-clearance conditions • compliance monitoring • Mechanism chain • Qualified use •
The National Green Tribunal • NGT Act

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not assume unlimited NGT jurisdiction over every environmental dispute.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: NGT statutory identity - Original-jurisdiction boundary Qualified use: Move from condition to monitoring, compliance evidence and corrective action.

SESSION 12 - CORE - NGT STATUTORY IDENTITY AND ORIGINAL JURISDICTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Appellate-jurisdiction boundary Qualified use: Define NGT and then locate the substantial question within its statutory boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- NGT statutory identity
- original jurisdiction
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- NGT
- Appellate-jurisdiction

How to use them: Frame the answer through NGT statutory identity; define original jurisdiction, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use NGT for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NGT STATUTORY IDENTITY AND ORIGINAL JURISDICTION

01. Appellate-jurisdiction boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge original and appellate jurisdiction.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge original and appellate jurisdiction.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Define NGT and then locate the substantial question within its statutory boundary.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary
- **Qualified use:** Define NGT and then locate the substantial question within its statutory boundary.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - NGT STATUTORY IDENTITY AND ORIGINAL JURISDICTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - NGT statutory identity and original jurisdiction
|
v
EXACT TERMS: NGT statutory identity · original jurisdiction · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · NGT
· Appellate-jurisdiction
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Appellate-jurisdiction boundary Qualified use: Define NGT
and then locate the substantial question within its statutory boundary.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge original and appellate jurisdiction.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not merge original and appellate
jurisdiction.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions
under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional
writ review.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - NGT APPELLATE JURISDICTION AND REMEDIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Remedy boundary Qualified use: Identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

Technical definition: Mains: Identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- NGT appellate jurisdiction
- remedies
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Relief

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define NGT appellate jurisdiction, connect remedies with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NGT APPELLATE JURISDICTION AND REMEDIES

01. Remedy boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge compensation, property restitution and environmental restitution.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge compensation, property restitution and environmental restitution.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Remedy boundary
- **Qualified use:** Identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - NGT APPELLATE JURISDICTION AND REMEDIES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - NGT appellate jurisdiction and remedies

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · NGT appellate jurisdiction · remedies · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Relief

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Remedy boundary Qualified use: Identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge compensation, property restitution and environmental restitution.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: identify whether the case is an appeal and match the remedy to the provision.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - PRINCIPLES LIMITATION AND CONSTITUTIONAL COURTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Principles and adjudication - Limitation discipline Qualified use: Apply principles within jurisdiction and date the correct limitation route.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Principles limitation**
- **constitutional courts**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Sustainable**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Principles limitation, connect constitutional courts with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PRINCIPLES LIMITATION AND CONSTITUTIONAL COURTS

01. Principles and adjudication

|
v

02. Limitation discipline

BOUNDARY -> Do not quote one limitation period for every NGT remedy.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.
- Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not quote one limitation period for every NGT remedy.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Apply principles within jurisdiction and date the correct limitation route.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Principles and adjudication -> Limitation discipline
- **Qualified use:** Apply principles within jurisdiction and date the correct limitation route.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - PRINCIPLES LIMITATION AND CONSTITUTIONAL COURTS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Principles limitation and constitutional courts

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Principles limitation · constitutional courts · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Sustainable

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Principles and adjudication - Limitation discipline
Qualified use: Apply principles within jurisdiction and date the correct limitation route.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not quote one limitation period for every NGT remedy.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - INSTRUMENT HIERARCHY AND EVIDENCE-SAFE SYNTHESIS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Constitutional-court boundary - Instrument and evidence boundary
Qualified use: Close by ranking statute, notification, amendment, order, memorandum and judgment correctly.

Technical definition: Rohit Prajapati (2020), and again in a 2025 ruling striking down the executive instruments that had permitted regularisation of projects begun without prior clearance. **ANALYSIS:** Verify the exact case name and date of the 2025 ruling before citing it.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Constitutional-court boundary - Instrument and evidence boundary
Qualified use: Close by ranking statute, notification, amendment, order, memorandum and judgment correctly.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Instrument hierarchy
- evidence-safe synthesis
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Instrument hierarchy, connect evidence-safe synthesis with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INSTRUMENT HIERARCHY AND EVIDENCE-SAFE SYNTHESIS

01. Constitutional-court boundary

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02. Instrument and evidence boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not present a draft or office memorandum as a final notification or judgment.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.
- An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not present a draft or office memorandum as a final notification or judgment.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Close by ranking statute, notification, amendment, order, memorandum and judgment correctly.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Constitutional-court boundary -> Instrument and evidence boundary
- **Qualified use:** Close by ranking statute, notification, amendment, order, memorandum and judgment correctly.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II judicial-governance linkage. **Core area:** Project-clearance and environmental-litigation architecture. **Grounded in:** Environment Impact Assessment Notification, 2006 (under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986); National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 (India Code); audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. **Companion:** advanced/16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT.md.

1. Visual foundation

EIA NOTIFICATION, 2006 - PROJECT CATEGORY LADDER

Category A -> Clearance from CENTRAL MoEFCC (Expert Appraisal Committee)

Category B -> Clearance from STATE (SEIAA/State Expert Appraisal Committee)

B1 -> requires full EIA report/public consultation

B2 -> does NOT require a detailed EIA report (screened out of full assessment)

EIA PROCESS STAGES: Screening -> Scoping -> Public Consultation -> Appraisal -> Clearance

NGT (2010) - specialised tribunal for SPEEDY, EXPERT disposal of environmental cases, with both civil (compensation/restitution) and appellate (clearance-challenge) jurisdiction.

Core proposition: India's environmental-clearance system (EIA Notification, 2006) determines *before* a project starts whether and how its environmental impact will be assessed and mitigated, while the National Green Tribunal (2010) provides a specialised, faster judicial forum *after* clearance (or in its absence) to enforce environmental law and adjudicate related disputes - together forming a pre-emptive and corrective governance pair.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)	A structured process assessing the likely environmental consequences of a proposed project before it is approved.
FACT: Category A project	Projects requiring environmental clearance from the central MoEFCC, based on the Expert Appraisal Committee's review.
FACT: Category B project	Projects requiring clearance from the State Environment Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA); further split into B1 (needs full EIA/public consultation) and B2 (does not require detailed EIA).
FACT: Public consultation	A mandatory stage in the EIA process (for applicable projects) allowing affected communities and stakeholders to raise concerns before clearance is granted.
FACT: National Green Tribunal (NGT)	A specialised statutory tribunal (established under the NGT Act, 2010) with original and appellate jurisdiction over environment-related disputes, offering faster, technically informed adjudication than ordinary courts. India was among the first countries to set up such a dedicated environmental tribunal.
FACT: NGT's Schedule I laws	NGT jurisdiction extends to substantial questions relating to the environment arising under seven enactments: the Water Act, 1974; Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Cess Act, 1977; Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980; Air Act, 1981; Environment (Protection) Act, 1986; Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991; and Biological Diversity Act, 2002. ANALYSIS: The Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 and the Indian Forest Act, 1927 are NOT in Schedule I - one of the most reliably examined traps in this topic.
FACT: NGT composition and procedure	Chairperson (a retired Supreme Court judge or High Court Chief Justice) plus Judicial and Expert Members - a minimum of 10 and maximum of 20 of each in full-time service. The Tribunal is not bound by the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 or the Indian Evidence Act , but is guided by principles of natural justice . Applications are to be disposed of within six months , and an appeal lies to the Supreme Court within 90 days .
FACT: Polluter Pays Principle / Precautionary Principle	Foundational environmental-jurisprudence principles the NGT applies - the former placing remediation cost on the polluter, the latter allowing preventive action even without full scientific certainty of harm. Section 20 of the NGT Act directs the Tribunal to apply these along with sustainable development .
FACT: PARIVESH	Pro-Active and Responsive facilitation by Interactive, Virtuous and Environmental Single window Hub - the national single-window platform for environment, forest, wildlife and CRZ clearances. PARIVESH 3.0 integrates baseline environmental data, compensatory-afforestation land banks, inter-ministerial dashboards and AI-enabled support (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10).

3. Topic mechanism

1. A project proponent must first determine whether their project falls under the EIA

Notification's schedule and, if so, whether it is Category A (central clearance) or Category B (state clearance, further split into B1/B2 based on assessment requirement).

2. The clearance process runs through four stages - screening (determining applicability/ category), scoping (defining assessment terms of reference), public consultation (for projects requiring it) and appraisal (expert committee review) - culminating in a grant, conditional grant, or rejection of environmental clearance.

3. The National Green Tribunal, established specifically to provide specialised, expert and expeditious environmental justice, has original jurisdiction over substantial questions relating to environment arising from specified environmental laws (including the Environment Protection Act, Water Act, Air Act, Forest Conservation Act and Biological Diversity Act), and appellate jurisdiction to hear challenges to environmental clearances themselves.

4. NGT decisions apply established environmental-law principles (Polluter Pays, Precautionary Principle, Sustainable Development) alongside statutory provisions, allowing it to order compensation, restitution of the environment, and clearance modification/cancellation.

5. Together, the EIA process (preventive, pre-project) and NGT (corrective, post-facto adjudication and enforcement) form complementary layers - the EIA system aims to prevent environmental harm before it occurs, while the NGT provides recourse when clearance conditions are violated, clearances are wrongly granted, or environmental damage occurs.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **MoEFCC (Expert Appraisal Committee)**: appraises and grants/rejects Category A clearances.

- FACT: ****State Environment Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA) / State Expert Appraisal Committee (SEAC):**** appraises and grants/rejects Category B clearances.

- FACT: **National Green Tribunal (NGT), with a Principal Bench and regional benches**: adjudicates environmental disputes and clearance challenges.

- ANALYSIS: Supreme Court and High Courts retain constitutional writ jurisdiction over environmental matters, operating alongside (not replaced by) the NGT's specialised jurisdiction.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: Large infrastructure, mining and industrial projects typically fall under Category A, requiring central-level appraisal given their potential for significant, wide-reaching environmental impact.

- ANALYSIS: Public consultation processes for major projects (e.g., large dams, mining expansions) have historically been sites of significant local community engagement and, at times, contestation over the adequacy of consultation.

- ANALYSIS: NGT rulings have addressed a wide range of issues including river pollution, illegal construction in ecologically sensitive zones, air-quality violations, and clearance conditions for major projects - illustrating its broad environmental-law jurisdiction.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: The EIA Notification, 2006 classifies projects into Category A (central clearance) and Category B (state clearance, further divided into B1 and B2).

- FACT: The EIA process has four stages: screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal.

- FACT: The National Green Tribunal was established under the National Green Tribunal Act, 2010, for speedy and specialised disposal of environmental cases.

- FACT: NGT has both original jurisdiction (specified environmental-law disputes) and appellate jurisdiction (challenges to environmental clearances).

- FACT: The Polluter Pays Principle and the Precautionary Principle are foundational

environmental-jurisprudence principles applied by Indian courts and the NGT.

- FACT: NGT's original jurisdiction covers **seven** Schedule I enactments; the ****Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972** and the **Indian Forest Act, 1927** are excluded**.
- FACT: NGT is **not bound by the CPC, 1908 or the Indian Evidence Act, 1872** but must follow **natural justice**; cases are to be disposed of within **six months**, with appeal to the **Supreme Court within 90 days**.
- FACT: NGT's **Principal Bench is at New Delhi**, with regional benches at ****Bhopal, Pune, Kolkata and Chennai****.
- FACT: An application for compensation/relief must ordinarily be made within **five years** of the cause of action, while an appeal against a clearance order must be filed within **30 days** (extendable) - different limitation clocks for different remedies.
- FACT: **PARIVESH 3.0** is the single-window digital platform for environmental clearances and post-approval compliance monitoring; the **Environment Audit Rules, 2025** introduce **certified third-party environmental auditors** (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10).

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: All projects require environmental clearance under the EIA Notification. -> Only projects/activities specified in the Notification's schedule require clearance; others fall outside its scope.
- WRONG: Category B2 projects require a full detailed EIA report like B1. -> B2 projects are specifically screened out of the detailed EIA/public-consultation requirement.
- WRONG: NGT has replaced the Supreme Court/High Courts' jurisdiction over all environmental matters. -> NGT provides a specialised additional forum; constitutional courts retain their writ jurisdiction over environmental matters as well.
- WRONG: The Precautionary Principle requires full scientific certainty before any preventive action can be taken. -> It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.
- WRONG: Public consultation is mandatory for every category of project under the EIA Notification. -> It is specifically required for projects/activities that need a detailed EIA report (broadly, Category A and B1), not for all categories.
- WRONG: The NGT can hear any environmental dispute whatsoever. -> Its original jurisdiction is tied to substantial questions arising under **seven Schedule I enactments**; the **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972** and the **Indian Forest Act, 1927** are not among them.
- WRONG: The NGT follows the Code of Civil Procedure and the Evidence Act. -> It is expressly **not bound** by either, and instead follows principles of natural justice.
- WRONG: Environmental clearance can be regularised after a project has already started. -> The Supreme Court has repeatedly held that **ex post facto ("post-facto") clearance is alien to environmental jurisprudence** - most prominently in *Alembic Pharmaceuticals Ltd. v. Rohit Prajapati* (2020), and again in a 2025 ruling striking down the executive instruments that had permitted regularisation of projects begun without prior clearance. ANALYSIS: Verify the exact case name and date of the 2025 ruling before citing it.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: The EIA Notification, 2006 (as periodically amended) and the National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 remain the current governing legal framework; verify any proposed or notified changes to the EIA process (e.g., draft EIA notification revisions) against the latest MoEFCC gazette notification before citing an updated procedural detail.

ANALYSIS: **Interpretation caution:** proposals to amend the EIA process have periodically been debated publicly (e.g., regarding post-facto clearance provisions or public-consultation timelines) - cite the specific notification/draft and its date rather than assuming a settled final version. Distinguish rigorously between a **draft notification**, a **final gazette notification**, an **office memorandum** (executive instruction) and a **judgment** - these have very different

legal force, and questions on EIA reform are frequently designed to test exactly that distinction.

CURRENT: Direction of reform (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10): the government describes a shift toward "risk-based and outcome-oriented regulation", naming **PARIVESH 3.0** (single-window clearance and compliance monitoring), the **Environment Audit Rules, 2025** (certified third-party auditors), **uniform SPCB consent guidelines** following the Water and Air Act amendments, the extension of industry categories to include **Blue**, streamlined regulation for **critical, strategic and atomic mineral** mining projects, and the **October 2025** rationalisation of green-belt norms by pollution potential in place of the blanket 33% green-cover requirement for industrial estates. The Survey simultaneously acknowledges the unresolved problems: multiplicity of clearances and overlapping jurisdictions, weak post-clearance monitoring, SPCB capacity constraints, wide inter-state variation and high litigation-related uncertainty.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-III direct PYQ:** role of environmental NGOs/activists in influencing EIA outcomes, requiring **four properly sourced examples**.
- **FACT: 2025 GS-III cross-route:** mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures; use this file for EIA/clearance/closure governance and Geography topic 31 for mineral occurrence. Exact routes: . . /README . md.
- **ANALYSIS:** Recurring Prelims pattern: distinguish Category A/B/B1/B2 clearance requirements and identify the four EIA process stages correctly.
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains linkage: NGT case examples are used to illustrate the application of the Polluter Pays and Precautionary Principles in Indian environmental jurisprudence.

10. Mains angles

- **ANALYSIS:** Argue that a rigorous, genuinely consultative EIA process is the most effective preventive tool for avoiding environmental harm, making its integrity (not just its existence) the key governance question.
- **ANALYSIS:** Use NGT case law to argue for the practical application of environmental-jurisprudence principles (Polluter Pays, Precautionary Principle, Sustainable Development) beyond textbook definitions.
- **ANALYSIS:** Conclude with a prevention-and-correction thesis: environmental governance needs both a credible pre-project clearance process and an accessible, expert post-facto adjudication mechanism - neither is sufficient alone.

Answer thesis: Treat the EIA process as India's preventive environmental-clearance mechanism and the NGT as its corrective, specialised judicial-enforcement mechanism, and judge both by the integrity of their implementation (genuine public consultation, timely and enforced NGT orders) rather than their existence on paper alone.

11. Probable questions

- **ANALYSIS: Prelims:** Distinguish Category A, B1 and B2 projects under the EIA Notification, 2006, and state the four stages of the EIA process.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** Explain the Polluter Pays Principle and the Precautionary Principle with reference to Indian environmental jurisprudence.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks):** Discuss the role of the National Green Tribunal in strengthening environmental governance in India, with examples.

12. Study links

- **FACT:** Advanced companion: advanced/16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT . md.
- **FACT:** 01_Ecosystem-Structure-and-Function . md - the ecosystem-services valuation gap in EIA practice.

- FACT: 13_Air-Pollution-and-CPCB-Standards.md and 14_Water-Pollution-and-River-Cleaning-Missions.md - pollution-control law frequently adjudicated by the NGT.
- FACT: 27_Environmental-Institutions-MoEFCC-CPCB-NBA-WII.md - MoEFCC's clearance-appraisal institutional role.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	8	Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes	Cite examples · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2025	GS-III	17	Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes
- Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

13. Core answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Direct demand A - NGOs/activists and EIA outcomes (2024 GS-III, 10 marks)

Thesis: NGOs and affected citizens improve EIA outcomes by making baseline gaps, livelihood impacts and compliance failures visible through hearings, independent evidence and judicial review; they influence scrutiny, conditions, remand or refusal, but are not a substitute for expert appraisal or elected administration.

Case / participation route	Documented influence on the project process	Precise status discipline
Mopa Greenfield Airport, Goa - Hanuman Laxman Aroskar v. Union of India, Supreme Court, 29 March 2019	Citizen-environmental litigation exposed appraisal/baseline and safeguard concerns; the Court required a fresh expert review and suspended the earlier environmental-clearance route pending that exercise.	Use it as an EIA-quality and judicial-review example; do not call it a permanent project cancellation, since later orders/conditions changed the project's procedural position.
Niyamgiri bauxite proposal, Odisha - Orissa Mining Corporation v. MoEF, 18 April 2013	Dongria Kondh mobilisation and the Court-directed Gram Sabha process made forest, religious and livelihood impacts decision-relevant; the process preceded the final forest-clearance refusal.	This is principally a forest-rights/forest-clearance and community-consent example, not a routine EIA-2006 public-hearing precedent. State that boundary.
POSCO steel project, Jagatsinghpur, Odisha - Prafulla Samantray v. Union of India, NGT Appeal 8/2011, 30 March 2012	The challenge exposed appraisal of only the first 4-MTPA phase of a proposed 12-MTPA project; NGT suspended/set aside the 31 January 2011 EC pending a fresh full-project review and monitoring conditions.	Do not claim activism alone "cancelled" the project; distinguish the NGT's procedural remedy from the later commercial and policy decision not to proceed.
Kudremukh iron-ore mining, Karnataka - T.N. Godavarman/K.M. Chinnappa v. Union of India, 30 October 2002	Wildlife First's conservation litigation placed mining inside the National Park under a precautionary framework; the Court confined work to already broken land, barred fresh area/pipeline activity and required wind-up by end-2005 with reclamation.	It is a wildlife/protected-area judicial-enforcement example, not a textbook 2006 EIA hearing; use it to show the wider project-accountability ecosystem.

150-word spine: define information/representation role -> give four one-line examples with their route and bounded outcome -> note risks of selective expertise/delay -> verdict: transparent evidence, accessible hearings and reasoned appraisal strengthen rather than replace legitimate development.

13.2 Direct demand B - mining as environmental hazard (2025 GS-III, 15 marks)

Hazard chain: vegetation/topsoil removal and fragmentation -> erosion and habitat loss; drilling, blasting, haulage and crushing -> dust/noise; overburden/tailings and sulphide exposure -> sediment/chemical drainage risk; dewatering and waste disposal -> groundwater/surface-water stress; abandoned workings/dumps -> long-lived safety and restoration liability.

Remedy	Why it answers the hazard
Strategic siting, cumulative impact assessment and meaningful public consultation before clearance	Avoids putting a mine in an ecologically or socially irreplaceable landscape.
Mine plan/EMP, pollution control, water balance and independent compliance monitoring	Controls active dust, effluent, noise and dewatering pathways.
Progressive reclamation: topsoil conservation, backfilling/stable dumps, native-biome restoration and closure finance	Prevents a deferred abandoned-mine liability; restoration begins during, not after, extraction.
Community/FRA due diligence, disclosure and grievance redress	Makes livelihood, rights and benefit-sharing risks visible rather than treating geology as the only variable.

Use **Kudremukh** as a named conservation-risk case and **Jharia coalfield fires** only as an extraction-legacy illustration; do not attach unverified area, casualty or financial figures. Close: mineral security does not justify treating a clearance or closure plan as proof of achieved restoration.

13.3 Universal EIA/NGT spine

For any 10/15/20 marker: classify project and stage -> identify baseline, alternatives and affected rights -> test consultation quality -> use precaution/polluter-pays/sustainable-development principles -> distinguish notification, office memorandum and judgment -> conclude with enforceable post-clearance monitoring. Ex post facto clearance cannot recreate the preventive choice that prior appraisal was meant to inform.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 6

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	4	National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Cross-routed to environmental specialist and tribunal-versus-regulator classification; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	58	Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - INSTRUMENT HIERARCHY AND EVIDENCE-SAFE SYNTHESIS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Instrument hierarchy and evidence-safe synthesis

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v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Instrument hierarchy · evidence-safe synthesis · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Subject

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v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer. <!-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

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v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not present a draft or office memorandum as a final notification or judgment.

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v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Constitutional-court boundary - Instrument and evidence boundary Qualified use: Close by ranking statute, notification, amendment, order, memorandum and judgment correctly.

ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** EIA is a prior decision-support and clearance process with screening, scoping, appraisal, public consultation and conditions, while NGT is a statutory adjudicatory forum with defined jurisdiction and limitation rules.
- **Close distinction:** EIA notification is not an Act, Terms of Reference are not clearance, public hearing is not veto, ex post facto regularisation is not ordinary prior clearance, and NGT is not a criminal court or every environmental authority.
- **Mechanism / status / evidence limit:** State project category, competent authority, notification/rule vintage, stage, exemption and judicial status; separate draft proposal, final notification, clearance, compliance monitoring and remedy.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Prior EC boundary?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: A. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Prior EC boundary?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: B. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Prior EC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: C. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Prior EC boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: D. Explanation: Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies EC and consent boundary?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: A. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of EC and consent boundary?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses EC and consent boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: C. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about EC and consent boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: D. Explanation: Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: A. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Multiple-clearance boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: C. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Multiple-clearance boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: D. Explanation: Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule applicability?

A. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: A. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule applicability?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: B. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Schedule applicability without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: C. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule applicability?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: D. Explanation: The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category A and B boundary?

A. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: A. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments

or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category A and B boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: B. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Category A and B boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category A and B boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.

Answer: D. Explanation: Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies B1 and B2 boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: A. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of B1 and B2 boundary?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: B. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses B1 and B2 boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about B1 and B2 boundary?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.

Answer: D. Explanation: The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Screening boundary?

A. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Screening boundary?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Screening boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Screening boundary?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.

Answer: D. Explanation: Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Scoping and terms of reference?

A. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Scoping and terms of reference?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Scoping and terms of reference without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Scoping and terms of reference?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment evidence?

A. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment evidence?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: B. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Assessment evidence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: C. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment evidence?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.

Answer: D. Explanation: A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Public-consultation boundary?

A. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: A. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Public-consultation boundary?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: B. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Public-consultation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: C. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Public-consultation boundary?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Appraisal and decision?

A. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: A. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appraisal and decision?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: B. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Appraisal and decision without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: C. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appraisal and decision?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Post-clearance compliance?

A. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: A. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Post-clearance compliance?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: B. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Post-clearance compliance without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: C. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status

categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-clearance compliance?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Answer: D. Explanation: A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies NGT statutory identity?

A. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NGT statutory identity?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses NGT statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NGT statutory identity?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: A. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: B. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Original-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: C. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Original-jurisdiction boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.

Answer: D. Explanation: NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: A. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: B. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Appellate-jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: C. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Appellate-jurisdiction boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.

Answer: D. Explanation: NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Remedy boundary?

A. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: A. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Remedy boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: B. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other

options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Remedy boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Remedy boundary?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Principles and adjudication?

A. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Principles and adjudication?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options

belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Principles and adjudication without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Principles and adjudication?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Limitation discipline?

A. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. B. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Limitation discipline?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. C. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: B. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Limitation discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Limitation discipline?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Constitutional-court boundary?

A. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Constitutional-court boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. C. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Constitutional-court boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. C. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. D. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Constitutional-court boundary?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. B. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. C. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. D. Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.

Answer: A. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. B. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Answer: B. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Instrument and evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. D. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.

Answer: C. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Instrument and evidence boundary?

A. The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. B. Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. C. The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. D. An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Answer: D. Explanation: An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED EIA, CLEARANCE, NGT AND ENVIRONMENTAL-JUSTICE PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route direct Mains demands on EIA reform, NGO and activist influence, mining hazards and constitutional environmental adjudication, plus objective distinctions between NGT and CPCB and Environment Protection Act powers. No answer key is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-III direct PYQ:** role of environmental NGOs/activists in influencing EIA outcomes, requiring **four properly sourced examples**.
- **FACT: 2025 GS-III cross-route:** mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures; use this file for EIA/clearance/closure governance and Geography topic 31 for mineral occurrence. Exact routes: . . /README . md.
- **ANALYSIS:** Recurring Prelims pattern: distinguish Category A/B/B1/B2 clearance requirements and identify the four EIA process stages correctly.
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains linkage: NGT case examples are used to illustrate the application of the Polluter Pays and Precautionary Principles in Indian environmental jurisprudence.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025 . md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	8	Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes	Cite examples · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2025	GS-III	17	Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Role of environmental NGOs and activists in EIA outcomes
- Mining as an environmental hazard and remedial measures

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023 . md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023 . md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023 . md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I

- Routed question demands: 6

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	4	National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Cross-routed to environmental specialist and tribunal-versus-regulator classification; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	58	Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- National Green Tribunal versus Central Pollution Control Board
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Environment Protection Act 1986 Government of India powers
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 GS-III direct PYQ:** NGOs/activists influencing EIA outcomes, with four evidence-backed examples-not generic advocacy claims.
- FACT: **2025 GS-III cross-route:** mining hazard/remedies; analyse appraisal, compliance, reclamation and mine closure here, with resource geography in Geography topic 31. Exact routes: . . /README . md.
- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on NGT jurisdiction should be answered by applying the specified-statute-schedule rule rather than assuming unlimited environmental jurisdiction.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "EIA effectiveness" or "NGT's role" should explicitly engage the

post-facto-clearance controversy and the implementation-capacity limitation to demonstrate analytical depth beyond a purely descriptive account.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim

examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
- Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
- Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish prior environmental clearance from pollution-control consent. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
- Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects

clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Scoping and terms of reference. **Named evidence/example:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the

owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.
- A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory

scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appraisal and decision. **Named evidence/example:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the evidence chain from baseline study to post-clearance monitoring. Answer in about...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.

- NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.
- NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.
- The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim

examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constitutional-court boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final

minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish NGT original and appellate jurisdiction. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
- The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.
- Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
- A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.
- A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.
- The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.
- Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.
- Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution

of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable

development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Prior EC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule applicability. **Named evidence/example:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Screening boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment evidence. **Named evidence/example:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Post-clearance compliance. **Named evidence/example:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Remedy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Principles and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate India's preventive EIA and corrective NGT architecture. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named

law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status,

metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
- Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.
- Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.
- The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.
- Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
- NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.
- NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.
- Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.
- An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal

link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** EC and consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Multiple-clearance boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category A and B boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** B1 and B2 boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Public-consultation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Original-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone

does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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4. **Claim and named evidence:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

7. **Claim and named evidence:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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owner. **Claim:** Appellate-jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Limitation discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Instrument and evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Build a legally disciplined project-clearance and remedy answer. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, with GS-II judicial-governance linkage. **Core area:** Project-clearance and environmental-litigation architecture. **Grounded in:** EIA Notification, 2006 (as amended) and draft-EIA public debate record; National Green Tribunal Act, 2010; landmark NGT/Supreme Court environmental jurisprudence; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. *Companion:* basic/16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT.md.

1. The "post-facto clearance" controversy: the central EIA-reform debate

ANALYSIS: The most examinable controversy in this topic is the debate around **post-facto (retrospective) environmental clearance** - the practice of granting environmental clearance to a project *after* it has already started or completed construction/operation without prior clearance. Critics argue this fundamentally inverts the EIA's preventive logic (assessing impact before commitment of resources) and can function as an ex-post regularisation of violations rather than genuine impact assessment; supporters argue it provides a pragmatic mechanism to bring already-existing but uncleared projects under environmental compliance and monitoring rather than leaving them entirely unregulated. Indian courts and the NGT have engaged with this tension over time, generally treating post-facto clearance as an exceptional, not a routine, mechanism - a nuance advanced answers should capture rather than treating post-facto clearance as either uniformly banned or uniformly permitted.

2. Public consultation: design intent versus documented critique

1. **FACT:** Public consultation (comprising a public hearing and a written-comments process) is

designed to surface local community concerns, livelihood impacts and additional environmental information before an Expert Appraisal Committee finalises its recommendation.

2. ANALYSIS: **Documented critiques** include: inadequate advance notice/access to draft EIA reports for affected communities (particularly in remote or low-literacy areas), language-accessibility gaps (EIA reports often being highly technical and not always fully translated/simplified for local stakeholders), and instances where public-hearing logistics (venue, timing) have been contested as limiting genuine participation.

3. ANALYSIS: **Balanced framing**: the public-consultation requirement's statutory design is sound in intent; the recurring critique is one of implementation quality and genuine two-way engagement, not the absence of a consultation requirement itself.

3. NGT's institutional design: strengths and jurisdictional limitations

Feature	Design strength	Documented limitation
FACT: Technical expertise (judicial + expert members)	Enables scientifically informed adjudication of complex environmental disputes.	Bench strength and regional-bench availability have periodically faced capacity/staffing constraints affecting case-disposal speed.
FACT: Broad original jurisdiction over specified environmental statutes	Covers most major environmental laws (EPA, Water Act, Air Act, Forest Conservation Act, Biological Diversity Act) under one forum.	The NGT Act's specified schedule of covered laws means some environment-adjacent matters (e.g., certain wildlife-protection matters) have at times raised jurisdictional questions about whether NGT or ordinary courts are the appropriate forum.
FACT: Suo motu (self-initiated) cognisance in various instances	Allows the tribunal to act on environmental harm even without a formal petitioner in some circumstances, aiding proactive enforcement.	Enforcement of NGT orders ultimately depends on executive/state agency compliance, and implementation of tribunal directions has not always been uniformly swift.

ANALYSIS: **Analytical synthesis**: the NGT's core strength (specialised technical adjudication) is well-established, but its practical effectiveness is bounded by the same implementation-capacity constraints seen elsewhere in Indian environmental governance - namely, the gap between a well-designed judicial/administrative mechanism and the executive capacity to actually implement its directions on the ground.

4. The EIA-versus-development-imperative tension in policy debate

- ANALYSIS: Periodic proposals to streamline or revise the EIA process (e.g., reducing timelines, adjusting public-consultation requirements, or expanding categories eligible for reduced scrutiny) have generated public debate between two legitimate policy goals: accelerating infrastructure/investment approval timelines (a stated economic-development priority) and preserving the rigour of environmental safeguards (an ecological/public-health priority).
- ANALYSIS: **Balanced framing for Mains**: present this as a genuine trade-off requiring careful calibration - procedural delays that serve no genuine assessment purpose can reasonably be streamlined, but streamlining that removes substantive public consultation or expert scrutiny risks undermining the EIA's core preventive function; the specific reform proposal's actual provisions (not simply "faster" or "slower") determine whether it is a genuine improvement or a rigour-reducing change.

5. Data and conceptual limitations

- ANALYSIS: Comprehensive, independently compiled national data on EIA clearance approval/rejection rates, average processing timelines, and post-facto clearance frequency is not centrally published in one standardised, easily citable dataset; specific claims about approval rates or timelines should be attributed to the particular MoEFCC/parliamentary report cited, with its date.
- ANALYSIS: NGT case-disposal statistics (pendency, average disposal time) are reported periodically and vary by bench; a general claim about NGT "speed" should be qualified by the specific period/bench data referenced rather than presented as a constant, uniform fact.

6. Recurring UPSC analytical tensions

Tension	Balanced framing
Post-facto clearance as pragmatic regularisation vs preventive-logic inversion	Courts/NGT have generally treated it as an exceptional mechanism rather than routine practice - the analytical position should reflect this "exceptional, not routine" judicial stance.
Streamlining EIA timelines vs preserving substantive scrutiny	Genuine reform should target redundant procedural delay, not substantive public-consultation or expert-appraisal rigour.
Specialised NGT adjudication vs executive-compliance capacity	A well-designed tribunal is necessary but not sufficient without matching state/central agency capacity to implement its directions.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: Post-facto (retrospective) environmental clearance has been treated by Indian courts and the NGT as an exceptional mechanism, not a routine substitute for prior clearance, given its tension with the EIA's preventive logic.
- FACT: NGT's original jurisdiction covers substantial questions relating to environment arising under a specified schedule of environmental statutes (including the EPA, Water Act, Air Act, Forest Conservation Act and Biological Diversity Act).
- FACT: Public consultation under the EIA process has faced documented implementation critiques regarding notice adequacy, language accessibility and hearing logistics.
- FACT: NGT order implementation ultimately depends on executive/state-agency compliance capacity, a documented limitation distinct from the tribunal's own adjudicatory design.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Post-facto environmental clearance has been judicially endorsed as a routine, regular clearance mechanism. -> Courts/NGT have generally treated it as an exceptional mechanism, reflecting concern over its tension with the EIA's preventive purpose.
- WRONG: NGT has unlimited jurisdiction over every environment-related legal matter in India. -> Its original jurisdiction is defined by a specified schedule of environmental statutes, and some environment-adjacent matters have raised jurisdictional questions.
- WRONG: Public-consultation critiques primarily concern the absence of any consultation requirement. -> The requirement exists; critiques concern implementation quality (notice, accessibility, logistics), not its statutory absence.
- WRONG: NGT orders are self-executing and require no further executive action. -> Implementation of NGT directions depends on executive/state-agency compliance capacity.

9. CURRENT: Current anchor - analytical use

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: EIA Notification, 2006 (as periodically amended) and NGT Act, 2010 - current governing framework (verify any specific proposed amendment/draft notification and its date before citing).	Use as the baseline for evaluating any EIA-reform proposal against the preventive-versus-streamlining trade-off framework in Section 4.
CURRENT: PARIVESH 3.0 , the Environment Audit Rules, 2025 (certified third-party auditors), uniform SPCB consent guidelines, the new Blue industry category, and the October 2025 green-belt rationalisation (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10).	The Survey's own framing is a " trust-based, outcome-oriented " shift. The sharpest balanced critique writes itself: trust-based regulation presupposes credible verification, and the Survey <i>itself</i> lists weak post-clearance monitoring and SPCB capacity constraints among the unresolved problems. Quote both halves - it demonstrates you read the source rather than the headline.
CURRENT: The Survey's own list of persisting weaknesses: multiplicity of clearances and overlapping jurisdictions, weak post-clearance monitoring, SPCB capacity constraints, significant inter-state variation, and high litigation-related uncertainty (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10).	This is a government-sourced critique , which is far more persuasive in an answer than an activist-sourced one. Use it as the evidentiary spine of any "is India's EIA regime effective?" answer.
FACT: Supreme Court jurisprudence against ex post facto environmental clearance - <i>Alembic Pharmaceuticals Ltd. v. Rohit Prajapati</i> (2020), reinforced by a 2025 ruling invalidating the executive route to regularising projects started without prior clearance. ANALYSIS: Verify the 2025 case name and date before citing.	The doctrinal anchor for the whole topic: prior clearance is not a procedural formality but the substance of the preventive principle, because an assessment conducted after construction cannot alter the decision it was meant to inform.

ANALYSIS: **Instrument-hierarchy discipline**: an **office memorandum** cannot override a **notification**, and neither can override a **statute** or a binding **judgment**. Several EIA controversies of the last decade are, at their core, disputes about this hierarchy - saying so explicitly is a high-value analytical move.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 GS-III direct PYQ**: NGOs/activists influencing EIA outcomes, with four evidence-backed examples-not generic advocacy claims.
- FACT: **2025 GS-III cross-route**: mining hazard/remedies; analyse appraisal, compliance, reclamation and mine closure here, with resource geography in Geography topic 31. Exact routes: `.. /README.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on NGT jurisdiction should be answered by applying the specified-statute-schedule rule rather than assuming unlimited environmental jurisdiction.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "EIA effectiveness" or "NGT's role" should explicitly engage the post-facto-clearance controversy and the implementation-capacity limitation to demonstrate analytical depth beyond a purely descriptive account.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: India's EIA process and NGT together form a preventive-and-corrective environmental-governance pair whose statutory design is sound, but whose real effectiveness depends on resisting the erosion of substantive scrutiny (particularly around post-facto clearance and public-consultation quality) and on strengthening executive capacity to implement NGT directions - procedural streamlining and judicial specialisation alone cannot substitute for these implementation fundamentals.

1. Define the EIA's Category A/B1/B2 structure and the four-stage process, and NGT's original/appellate jurisdiction.
2. Introduce the post-facto-clearance controversy as the central EIA-reform debate, presenting the judicial "exceptional, not routine" stance.
3. Analyse public-consultation implementation critiques (notice, accessibility, logistics) as a quality, not existence, problem.
4. Evaluate NGT's institutional strengths and its bounded effectiveness given executive-

compliance dependency.

5. Conclude with a calibrated-reform recommendation: streamline redundant procedure while preserving substantive scrutiny and strengthening NGT-order implementation capacity.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: Identify the correct jurisdictional scope of the NGT and the judicial stance on post-facto environmental clearance.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks)**: Why is post-facto environmental clearance considered controversial, and how have courts/NGT approached it?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks)**: Critically evaluate whether India's EIA process adequately balances development imperatives with environmental safeguards.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: basic/16_Environmental-Impact-Assessment-and-NGT.md.
- FACT: 01_Ecosystem-Structure-and-Function.md - the ecosystem-services valuation gap in EIA practice, discussed there.
- FACT: 06_Protected-Area-Network-India.md - ESZ jurisprudence intersecting with EIA/NGT matters.
- FACT: 27_Environmental-Institutions-MoEFCC-CPCB-NBA-WII.md - MoEFCC's Expert Appraisal Committee institutional role in full.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II, GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-I	15	Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts	How can it be restored · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-III	7	Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification	How does · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	1	Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court	Discuss with case laws · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; judicial review and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- Restoring mountain ecosystems from development and tourism impacts
- Draft EIA Notification 2020 differences from 2006 notification
- Constitutionalization of environmental problems by the Supreme Court

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: PRIOR EC, DISTINCT APPROVALS, CATEGORY AND PROCESS MAP

1. **Prior EC boundary:** Prior environmental clearance is a project-appraisal decision required before the prohibited starting point under the applicable notification; it is not a post-construction certificate of impact management.
2. **EC and consent boundary:** Environmental clearance and Consent to Establish or Operate arise from different instruments and authorities; possession of one does not grant or prove the other.
3. **Multiple-clearance boundary:** Environmental, forest, wildlife and coastal clearances protect different legal interests; one approval cannot be treated as a substitute for all others.
4. **Schedule applicability:** The first EIA question is whether the proposed project or activity falls within the current notification and schedule; not every project automatically requires the same appraisal route.
5. **Category A and B boundary:** Category A and Category B allocation determines the competent appraisal level under the owner, but the current schedule and thresholds must be checked before classifying a real project.
6. **B1 and B2 boundary:** The B1-B2 distinction affects assessment and consultation requirements under the applicable notification; it must not be guessed from project size or label without the owner and current schedule.
7. **Screening boundary:** Screening determines the applicable assessment route where the notification requires it; it is distinct from scoping, public consultation, appraisal and the final clearance decision.
8. **Scoping and terms of reference:** Scoping identifies the significant issues and terms of reference for study; it does not itself grant clearance or establish that baseline evidence is adequate.
9. **Assessment evidence:** A credible EIA examines baseline conditions, alternatives, likely impacts, mitigation and an environmental management plan; prediction remains bounded by data quality and assumptions.
10. **Public-consultation boundary:** Public consultation is a defined process for applicable projects, not a universal stage without exceptions; every claimed exemption, notice period or hearing rule must be tied to the current notification.
11. **Appraisal and decision:** An expert committee appraises the record and recommends a decision, while the competent authority grants, conditions or rejects clearance; recommendation and final order are distinct.
12. **Post-clearance compliance:** A granted clearance and listed conditions are inputs to compliance monitoring; neither proves that safeguards were implemented or environmental outcomes achieved.
13. **NGT statutory identity:** The National Green Tribunal is a specialised statutory adjudicatory body under the NGT Act, 2010; it is not the pollution-control regulator or the project appraisal committee.
14. **Original-jurisdiction boundary:** NGT original jurisdiction concerns substantial environmental questions arising from the enactments within its statutory boundary; an environment-related label alone does not create jurisdiction.
15. **Appellate-jurisdiction boundary:** NGT appellate jurisdiction attaches to specified appealable decisions under the governing statutes; it is distinct from original civil jurisdiction and constitutional writ review.
16. **Remedy boundary:** Relief or compensation to affected persons, restitution of property and restitution of the environment are distinct statutory remedies; a remedy must match jurisdiction and evidence.
17. **Principles and adjudication:** Sustainable development, precaution and polluter-pays guide NGT adjudication within the Act; they do not erase statutory jurisdiction, procedure or proof requirements.

18. **Limitation discipline:** Original applications, compensation claims and statutory appeals can have different limitation clocks and extension rules; no period is stated without the exact provision and remedy.
19. **Constitutional-court boundary:** The NGT does not replace Supreme Court or High Court constitutional jurisdiction; tribunal review, statutory appeal and writ review remain distinct routes.
20. **Instrument and evidence boundary:** An EIA notification, draft proposal, amendment, office memorandum, clearance order and judgment have different legal force; audited PYQs and live pages are used without inventing thresholds, exemptions, penalties or current claims.

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: CONSULTATION, COMPLIANCE, JURISDICTION, REMEDY AND LIMITATION TRAPS

- Do not merge prior environmental clearance with CTE or CTO.
- Do not treat environmental clearance as forest, wildlife or coastal clearance.
- Do not assume every project follows the same EIA route.
- Do not assign Category A, B, B1 or B2 without the current schedule.
- Do not merge screening with scoping or appraisal.
- Do not treat terms of reference as project approval.
- Do not assume public consultation has no project-specific exceptions.
- Do not treat an expert recommendation as the final clearance order.
- Do not treat clearance conditions as proof of compliance.
- Do not call NGT a pollution-control board or appraisal committee.
- Do not assume unlimited NGT jurisdiction over every environmental dispute.
- Do not merge original and appellate jurisdiction.
- Do not merge compensation, property restitution and environmental restitution.
- Do not quote one limitation period for every NGT remedy.
- Do not present a draft or office memorandum as a final notification or judgment.

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: EIA-NGT GOVERNANCE ANSWER SPINE

TEST EIA SCHEDULE APPLICABILITY BEFORE CLASSIFYING THE PROJECT
-> SEPARATE PRIOR EC, CTE, CTO, FOREST, WILDLIFE AND CRZ APPROVALS
-> TRACE SCREENING, SCOPING, CONSULTATION, APPRAISAL AND DECISION
-> TEST BASELINE, ALTERNATIVES, MITIGATION, EMP AND COMPLIANCE
-> DISTINGUISH NGT ORIGINAL AND APPELLATE JURISDICTION
-> MATCH RELIEF, COMPENSATION, RESTITUTION AND LIMITATION TO THE REMEDY
-> CONCLUDE WITH PREVENTION, REASONED DECISION AND ENFORCEABLE MONITORING

Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT: LIVE THRESHOLD, EXEMPTION, PENALTY, CASE AND PYQ EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

MoEFCC pages substantively supported only the preventive appraisal function and the NGT's statutory identity. PARIVESH and NGT FAQ pages were title-only, India Code returned HTTP 403 and the NGT home page failed at transport level. No project threshold, category, exemption, clearance stage, limitation period, penalty or current case claim was imported.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Prior-clearance firewall

PROJECT CONCEPT -> test EIA schedule applicability
PRIOR EC REQUIRED -> appraisal before prohibited start
CONDITIONAL GRANT OR REJECTION -> competent authority decision
CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATION -> only under applicable approvals
RULE -> later paperwork cannot recreate prior appraisal
MUST REMEMBER: EIA is a prior decision-support and clearance process with screening,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Approval matrix

ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE -> project impact appraisal
CTE OR CTO -> pollution-control consent
FOREST CLEARANCE -> forest-law decision
WILDLIFE OR CRZ APPROVAL -> separate legal interest
NO SUBSTITUTION -> each approval retains its own test

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Classification gate

PROJECT OR ACTIVITY -> read current schedule
THRESHOLD AND LOCATION -> apply notified criteria
CATEGORY A OR B -> competent appraisal level
B1 OR B2 -> assessment route only where supported
NO GUESS -> title or size alone is insufficient

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Four-process distinction

SCREENING -> determine applicable route where required
SCOPING -> set significant issues and terms of reference
PUBLIC CONSULTATION -> receive affected and stakeholder concerns
APPRAISAL -> expert review of the full record
DECISION -> competent authority grants, conditions or rejects

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: EIA evidence chain

BASELINE -> existing environmental and social condition
ALTERNATIVES -> site, technology and no-project comparison
IMPACT PREDICTION -> magnitude, duration and uncertainty
MITIGATION -> avoid, minimise, restore or compensate
EMP AND MONITORING -> implementation and verification

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Consultation quality gate

APPLICABILITY -> read current notification
NOTICE AND ACCESS -> affected people can inspect material
HEARING OR WRITTEN RESPONSE -> collect concerns
APPRAISAL RESPONSE -> show how issues were considered
EXEMPTION CLAIM -> cite exact provision or do not assert it

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Recommendation-decision ladder

PROJECT RECORD -> EIA, EMP and consultation material
EXPERT COMMITTEE -> appraisal and recommendation
COMPETENT AUTHORITY -> final reasoned order
CONDITIONS -> enforceable project obligations
MONITORING -> evidence after grant

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Grant-to-outcome chain

CLEARANCE GRANTED -> legal decision
CONDITION LISTED -> required safeguard
ACTION IMPLEMENTED -> physical compliance
MONITORING VERIFIED -> evidence stage
OUTCOME -> environmental result, separately assessed

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: NGT identity map

NGT -> specialised statutory tribunal
CPCB OR SPCB -> pollution-control regulator
EAC OR SEAC -> appraisal committee
CLEARANCE AUTHORITY -> administrative decision-maker
CONSTITUTIONAL COURT -> writ and appellate constitutional role

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Jurisdiction fork

SUBSTANTIAL ENVIRONMENTAL QUESTION -> test Schedule I boundary
ORIGINAL CASE -> civil environmental dispute under the Act
APPEAL -> specified order and appeal provision
WRIT ROUTE -> separate constitutional review
NO LABEL-BASED JURISDICTION -> statute controls
CLOSE DISTINCTION: EIA notification is not an Act, Terms of Reference are not clearance,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Remedy and limitation matrix

RELIEF OR COMPENSATION -> person or damage claim
PROPERTY RESTITUTION -> restore affected property
ENVIRONMENT RESTITUTION -> repair environmental harm
LIMITATION -> remedy-specific clock and extension
PRINCIPLES -> apply within jurisdiction and evidence
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State project category, competent...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Instrument and answer spine

PREVENT -> applicability, category, study and consultation
DECIDE -> appraisal, reasoned order and distinct approvals
MONITOR -> conditions, compliance and environmental outcome
REMEDY -> NGT jurisdiction, appeal, relief and limitation
AUDIT -> draft, notification, memorandum, judgment and PYQ status